

as dynamic HTML. Therefore, it was decided that the rendering engine at the core of the browser needed a complete overhaul. Work began on a new engine from scratch, which was supposed to be the fifth iteration of the Netscape browser. Mozilla started out as an entity that oversaw the development of the codebase which was made public when Netscape Navigator (and its new rendering engine that was designed to better implement the web standards as defined by the W3C) was declared as Open Source and released to the public in 1998, around the time that Netscape itself was bought out by AOL. In 2003, AOL backed out of the project and Mozilla took on a larger role in the development of the browser.



The gist of the crusade

One of the defining features of Mozilla as an organisation is the degree to which it engages with its community. In fact, it's widely known that volunteers in every part of the organisation are the most important cogs in the wheel. Of course, positioning itself as a non-profit organisation endears it to those disillusioned by the pseudo-dictatorships in the tech scene. Working together with the people who share the Foundation's common values of openness – to paraphrase what's perhaps the most fitting description of its aims by a Mozilla employee – it's making the web what the world needs it to be.

A very significant development that we take for granted today, simply because we've grown so used to it being available that its absence would be considered blasphemy, is the abundance of free software around us. In an era that's so acutely money oriented, it almost seems counter-intuitive that so much of the internet is free. But it is, as championed by a huge Open Source community, of which Mozilla forms an integral part.

Despite being among the foremost web products of this day and age, one thing that strikes you about Firefox, and Mozilla in general, is that